

		Sections 597 and 597.5. The court, on its own motion, may make such an order at any time.” (Emphasis added.) Code of Civil Procedure section 1048(b) reads: “The court, in furtherance of convenience or to avoid prejudice, or when separate trials will be conducive to expedition and economy, <i>may</i> order a separate trial of any cause of action, including a cause of action asserted in a cross-complaint, or of any separate issue or of any number of causes of action or issues, preserving the right of trial by jury required by the Constitution or a statute of this state or of the United States.” (Emphasis added.) Though they utilize different methods, both sections allow the court to separate issues at trial to promote judicial economy and “avoid wasting court time.” (<i>Foreman & Clark Corp. v. Fallon</i> (1971) 3 Cal.3d 875, 888, fn. 8.) The determination of whether to bifurcate or sever claims is entrusted to the court’s broad discretion. (<i>Grappo v. Coventry Financial Corp.</i> (1991) 235 Cal.App.3d 496, 504; <i>Pilliod v. Monsanto Co.</i> (2021) 67 Cal.App.5th 591, 625–626.) Based on the record before the court, the requested bifurcation would not promote judicial economy. Accordingly, the motion is denied. Respondent Rafat Subhan is directed to give notice.
4	Rhodes – Trust; 30-2025-01527303-PR-TR-CMC	<i>Rhodes – Trust (2025-01527303)</i> Motion to Suspend; Motion to Appoint Eugene S. Rhodes’ Motion to Appoint Interim Professional Private Fiduciary to Replace Existing Co-Trustees (ROA 12) is GRANTED in part as set forth below. Paul M. Rhodes’ Motion for Suspension of Co-trustee Eugene S. Rhodes and Other Relief,